

“Let us wage  
a glorious  
struggle against  
**illiteracy,  
poverty, and  
terrorism**”.

MALALA YOUSAFZAI, IN HER SPEECH TO THE UN, 2013

## THE FIGHT FOR FEMALE EDUCATION

In October 2012, Pakistani teenager Malala Yousafzai was shot in the head by a Taliban gunman on her way home from school. Under Maulana Fazlullah's leadership, the Taliban had banned girls from education and blown up over 100 girls' schools in Pakistan's Swat Valley. Yousafzai had spoken out against the regime, through contacts in the US and a blog for the BBC, and her shooting was therefore a targeted assassination attempt. Miraculously, she survived and continued to protest; in 2013, Yousafzai made her first public appearance after the shooting, a visit to the United Nations, where she gave a speech to the assembled delegates. She went on to become a human rights activist and in 2014, became the youngest ever winner of the Nobel Peace Prize.

